`FileSystems.getDefault` is tangential to Akka. You can use it to access the file system in Java and to create a file, a path, and other containers for data, as well as other structures and mechanisms to support buffers.

It is important not to confuse `FileIO` (http://mng.bz/WAJd) with the Alpakka File Connector (https://doc.akka.io/docs/alpakka/current/file.html). The former creates a finite stream when reading, while the latter opens an infinite stream and gives you more options. As an infinite stream, it is meant to keep an open connection to an opened file and tail it.

Summary

- You can read from a Kafka topic using `Consumer.plainSource` and passing basic `ConsumerSettings`. The disadvantage of the basic consumer settings is that they don't preserve the offset. Therefore, when you restart the stream, you begin reading at the beginning or end of the topic.
- Adding `ConsumerConfig.ENABLE_AUTO_COMMIT_CONFIG` to `ConsumerSettings` keeps the offset as long as your application doesn't crash in the middle of a transaction.
- `Consumer.commitableSource` gives you at-least-once semantics, so you can ensure that no message is lost. Each message will be processed at least once.